The annotated source code for CoffeeScript is available online. Because CoffeeScript is written in CoffeeScript, you will, by now, be able to read it comfortably:

http://coffeescript.org/documentation/docs/coffee-script.html

To navigate to other parts of the documented source, use the Jump To link at the top right of the online CoffeeScript documentation pages.

In order to make changes to the CoffeeScript compiler, you first need to understand what it does. As with many things in CoffeeScript, you can understand much of this by experimentation on the REPL. At a high level, the CoffeeScript compiler understands the CoffeeScript you provide it by first splitting it into tokens, performing some rewrites on those tokens, and then creating an abstract syntax tree that's a representation of your CoffeeScript program. Figure 8.2 demonstrates the high-level steps that the CoffeeScript 1.6 compiler takes.

Figure 8.2. The internal CoffeeScript compilation process

